POINTS TO REMEMBER

- Merchandising is an important part of marketing and involves all activities necessary to determine and satisfy the wants and needs of a consumer.
- It is the planning and supervision involved in marketing a particular product and making it available at places, times, prices and in quantities that will best serve to realize the marketing objectives of a business.
- Apparel merchandising involves a constant watch of the production of the apparel products.
- The apparel supply chain involves five major sectors such as Fibres, Yarn sector, Fabric sector, Garment sector and Retail sector.
- Merchandiser is basically a co-ordinator, one who works between the buyer and apparel manufacturer to ensure quality merchandise at right delivery time.
- Merchandising involves all the activities right from communication to execution
- Garment manufacturing includes number of processes from order receiving to dispatching shipment of the finished garments. It includes merchandising department, sampling, fabric & accessories store department, spreading, marker planning and cutting department, sewing, washing department, quality control, pressing and folding, packing and despatching and administrative department.
- Categories of apparel merchandising includes Fashion merchandising, Apparel production or export merchandising and Apparel retail merchandising
- At every stage merchandiser has to co-ordinate with all the departments and follow up at every process
- Various steps in apparel merchandising includes fashion forecasting, sourcing , materials and production , buyer communication, enquiry and sampling, pre –costing, order confirmation and acceptance, order review, planning and programming, samples, accessories sourcing and purchasing, inspection, cutting and production, packing and shipment.
- Fashion Forecasting is the process of analyzing and predicting the future trends for the upcoming season in the industry
- Sourcing is procure of materials and/or production at a specified quality and service level
- Communication may be through letters, fax or e-mails
- Requisition sent by a buyer asking price details of the product which they want to place the order for, is an enquiry
- Pre-costing is the process of estimating the tentative price for the product. While doing costing various factors like style, fabric, colour and design, order quantity, current exchange rate and accessories have to be taken into consideration
- Planning includes the time calculation and scheduling of the order, the lead time
- Accessories can be generally classified into production accessories and packing accessories
- Sample is a product which represents a group, lot or batch.

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